

Lesson 38: “In Mine Own Way” (See L38 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand the principles of spiritual and temporal welfare and commit ourselves to greater self-reliance and service to the poor and needy.

1. Developing spiritual self-reliance

• D&C 38:30. But “if ye are prepared ye shall not fear.”

How have you found this counsel to be true in your life?

What does it mean to be self-reliant in spiritual things?

Why is it important to be spiritually self-reliant? †1. Elder Boyd K. Packer

How can we become more self-reliant in spiritual things?

How can parents help their children learn spiritual self-reliance?

2. Developing temporal self-reliance

What does it mean to be self-reliant in temporal things?

“We should use the blessings the Lord has given us to take care of ourselves and our families. When we are physically and emotionally able, we should not shift the burden of our own or our family’s care to someone else.” (*Lesson Manual*)

Why is it important to be temporally self-reliant?

How can we become more self-reliant in temporal things?

A. Work: Soon “after arriving in the Salt Lake Valley, President Brigham Young named the region *Deseret*, which is a word from the Book of Mormon meaning “a honey bee” (Ether 2:3). President Young wanted the Saints to be industrious in their new home and to work together for the common good, similar to honeybees. We should have this same attitude toward work in our lives.”

• D&C 42:42; 56:17. “Thou shalt not be idle; for he that is idle shall not eat the bread nor wear the garments of the laborer.” “Woe unto you poor men, whose hearts are not broken, ... who will not labor with your own hands!”

What value does work have in our lives? †2. Church Handbook of Instructions #1

How has work been a blessing in your life?

How have you learned the value of work? †3. Elder Neal A. Maxwell

B. Storage of food and other necessities: †4. Church Handbook of Instructions #2

What have you or others done to build up a supply of food storage?

How can having adequate food storage be a spiritual blessing as well as a temporal blessing?

C. Financial Security: “To be self-reliant, it is important that we know how to manage our money. Poor money management can lead to many problems in our individual and family lives.” (*Lesson Manual*)

What can we do to become more self-reliant in our finances?

How can parents teach children to be financially self-reliant? †5. Church Handbook of Instructions #3

How can paying tithing help us better manage our resources?

What practices have helped you avoid debt or get out of debt? †6. President Gordon B. Hinckley

3. Caring for the needy

a. [D&C 42:30–31](#). “And inasmuch as ye impart of your substance unto the poor, ye will do it unto me”.

b. [D&C 44:6](#). Ye “must visit the poor and the needy and administer to their relief”.

c. [D&C 52:40](#). For “he that doeth not these things, the same is not my disciple.”

d. [D&C 56:16](#). “Wo unto you rich ... that will not give your substance to the poor, for your riches will canker your souls”.

e. [D&C 88:123](#). “See that ye love one another; cease to be covetous; learn to impart one to another as the gospel requires.”

f. [D&C 104:18](#). If “any man ... impart not his portion ... unto the poor and the needy, he shall ... lift up his eyes in hell”.

• In [D&C 104:13–18](#), the Lord explains His way of providing for the temporal needs of His children.

What is the Lord’s “own way” of providing for the poor? †7. Lesson Manual Description of the Lord’s way

How are we blessed when we give to others who are in need? How have you been blessed by others?

What are some obstacles we may encounter in caring for the poor and needy?

How can we overcome these obstacles?

4. The Church Welfare program

See *Our Heritage*, [pages 108-109](#), and [pages 111-114](#).

†8. The First Presidency

Next Week: L39: “Hearts of the Children Shall Turn to Their Fathers”; See L39 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. **Elder Boyd K. Packer:** “We have been taught to store a year’s supply of food, clothing, and, if possible, fuel—at home. ... Can we not see that the same principle applies to inspiration and revelation, the solving of problems, to counsel, and to guidance? We need to have a source of it stored in every home. ...

“If we lose our emotional and spiritual independence, our self-reliance, we can be weakened quite as much, perhaps even more, than when we become dependent materially” (“[Solving Emotional Problems in the Lord’s Own Way](#),” *Ensign*, May 1978, 91–92).

†2. **Church Handbook of Instructions #1:** “To become self-reliant, a person must work. Work is physical, mental, or spiritual effort. It is a basic source of happiness, self-worth, and prosperity. Through work, people accomplish many good things in their lives” (*Church Handbook of Instructions, Book 2: Priesthood and Auxiliary Leaders* [1998], 257).

†3. **Elder Neal A. Maxwell:** “Our Heavenly Father has described His vast plan for His children by saying, ‘Behold, this is my work and my glory—to bring to pass the immortality and eternal life of man’ ([Moses 1:39](#); emphasis added). Consider the significance of the Lord’s use of the word work. What He is doing so lovingly and redemptively is, nevertheless, work—even for Him! We, likewise, speak of “working out our salvation,” of the “law of the harvest,” and of the “sweat of the brow” (see [Moses 5:1](#); see also Inspired Version, [Gen. 4:1](#)). These are not idle phrases. Instead, they underscore the importance of work. In fact, brethren, work is always a spiritual necessity even if, for some, work is not an economic necessity. (“[Put Your Shoulder to the Wheel](#),” *Ensign*, May 1998, 38).

†4. **Church Handbook of Instructions #2:** “Church leaders have not given an exact formula for what to store. Rather, they suggest that Church members begin by storing what would be required to keep them alive if they did not have anything else to eat. ...

“Through careful planning, most Church members can store a year’s supply of the basic items needed to sustain life. However, some members do not have the money or space for such storage, and some are prohibited by law from storing a year’s supply of food. These members should store as much as they can according to their circumstances. All members can provide themselves with added security by learning to produce and prepare basic food items” (Book 2, 258).

†5. **Church Handbook of Instructions #3:** “To become self-reliant in resource management, Church members should pay tithes and offerings, avoid unnecessary debt, save for the future, and satisfy all of their promised obligations. Members also should use their resources, including their time, frugally and avoid wasting them” (Book 2, 258).

†6. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “I urge you to be modest in your expenditures; discipline yourselves in your purchases to avoid debt to the extent possible. Pay off debt as quickly as you can, and free yourselves from bondage. ...

“... If you have paid your debts, if you have a reserve, even though it be small, then should storms howl about your head, you will have shelter for your wives and children and peace in your hearts” (“[To the Boys and to the Men](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1998, 54).

†7. **Lesson Manual description of the Lord’s way:** It “means helping those who are in need by giving according to what we have received from God. It means giving freely and lovingly, recognizing that Heavenly Father is the source of all blessings and that we are responsible to use them in the service of others. Those who receive this help should accept it with gratitude. They should use it to release themselves from the limitations of their need and to become more able to rise to their full potential. They should then reach out to help others.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†8. **The First Presidency:** “Our primary purpose was to set up, in so far as it might be possible, a system under which the curse of idleness would be done away with, the evils of a dole abolished, and independence, industry, thrift and self respect be once more established amongst our people. The aim of the Church is to help the people to help themselves. Work is to be re-enthroned as the ruling principle of the lives of our Church membership” (in Conference Report, [Oct. 1936, 3](#)).

Recommended reading:

1. Elder Boyd K. Packer, “[Solving Emotional Problems in the Lord’s Own Way](#),” *Ensign*, May 1978, 91–92.
2. Ted L. Gibbons, “[D&C Lesson 38](#): In Mine Own Way,” Sep. 13, 2013, [ldsliving.com](#).
3. Nancy Jensen, [D&C #38](#) “In Mine Own Way,” Sep. 15, 2013, LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus.
4. Val Dan Macmurray, “[Self-Sufficiency \(Self-Reliance\)](#),” *Encyclopedia of Mormonism*.

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